

Features

The largest, TFT-wise, is the 17.1-inch HP DV9223tx—a massive laptop that looks the proverbial Goliath to the ultra-portable Davids. Top-quality material and build is something we've come to expect from HP now, and this laptop epitomises it all. The black piano finish is classy, and the same, subtle rice-field-style design we spoke about on

the HP DV6226tx is present here. Once again, a set of blue backlit touch controls give a dash of colour to the functionality. In fact, there are more such controls, given the larger surface area HP had to play around with. The speakers are once again Altec Lansing, and once again excellent. The key travel is a little more than we'd like, and the slippery touchpad we have (sigh!) learnt to live with. Once again, a Media Center remote is bundled—couch potatoes, take heed!

ASUS' G1S looks like a large hunk of plastic with a carbon fibre top. This is an all-thrills, some-frills gaming laptop that is very clear about its reason for existence. Though not built on slim, attractive lines, the G1S isn't meant to be so, going instead with the beefy look. Pandering to the frag-happy fraternity is no easy task, but ASUS has been up to the challenge for some time now. The G1S uses a lot of green from the embedded dual fluorescent LED strips down each side of the cover to the very green-looking ASUS symbol for gaming, that for all the world looks like an "eye" to us to liven up things. There's a G2S, too, not tested here, that comes with blood-red lighting and matching colour tones.

That said, the G1S has a lovely, spacious keypad that returns brilliant feedback. The only issue is the misleading markings on the small Shift keys: we kept hitting the wrong key as a result. The matte-finished touchpad returns sweet feedback, and is smooth enough to not fatigue your finger while scrolling around during prolonged use. Equally nice are the play buttons on the front, mounted atop a grey steel bezel. Not so classy is the fluorescent green surrounding the webcam—a little overdone in our collective opinion. Incidentally, the G1S has a terrific set of speakers for a laptop.

The ASUS Lamborghini VX1 has a hood—umm, lid—just like its namesake. Did we mention it even looks like the famous automobile? With excellent materials and build quality, the VX1 is simply stunning, supermodel stuff, but then it has a pedigree to live up to! Once again an excellent keypad layout; brilliant feedback on both the keys and the touchpad make this laptop a pleasure to work with. The material on the palm rest area (some sort of buffed metal) is even better than HP's excellent piano finishes. The screen is a gorgeous 1400 x 1050 pixels, the highest-resolution TFT in this test.



ASUS G1S
Great for gaming, multimedia

ASUS' S6F is as tiny as its brothers are large. In fact, this would make a champion ultra-portable. It's small enough to pass off for a ladies' handbag, and the leather coating simply lulls your senses into believing it's little more than just that—a fancy handbag! Then there are the jewelled hinges and the ultra-attractive indicator LEDs for various functions. We also liked the unique coating on the keypad, and the dark grey really looks good. If any laptop was meant to look like a fashion accessory, this one looks the part. The screen, though tiny, is nonetheless crisp, and the keypad and touchpad work beautifully.

HP's TX1016au looks like it just stepped off a Versace ramp. Decked out in silver and black finery, the TX1016au is a Tablet PC complete with a swivelling screen, a bundled pen (no smudgy fingers on me please!), a wireless remote, and (oh joy!) a biometric device (fingerprint scanner). The swivel is extremely well-built: excellent fit and finish. The keypad is sufficiently tactile, although we didn't like the tiny Shift keys. The touchpad, which is sieve-patterned (heavily dimpled) returns ample feedback, but will result in a sore fingertips after extended use.

Performance

Based around Intel's latest Crestline (965PM) chipset, the ASUS G1S puts an Intel T7300 CPU and 2 GB of memory to proper use. The graphics solution is what any gamer worth his salt will be interested in, however, and with a



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Support Engineers
MCSE, CCNA or RHCE
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MBA (Marketing)
Experience required

Manager (Channel Sales)
MBA (Marketing)
Experienced in handling dealer channel

(above requirements are for all over India)

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